



Sofia de la Torre

Hello Detective,

My name is Sofia de la Torre, and my figure skating coach of over a decade was murdered last month. His name was Nathan LaPalma. His throat was slit with a figure skate blade that belonged to me. I'm currently the prime suspect.

I know I'm a stranger, but I'm begging you to help. I would never hurt Nathan. He was my idol, my mentor, and, to be honest, my only real friend. I need to see to it that his killer doesn't get away while the police waste valuable time interrogating me over and over and over again. They're so convinced I did it that they're not considering any other leads.

That's why I contacted Gray Investigations: to get a fresh pair of eyes on the case. Hopefully, a pair that's willing to give me the benefit of the doubt. Michelle Gray directed me to you, which means you might be my only chance to get Nathan the justice I owe him.

Nathan was the only stable, non-judgemental presence in my life. My parents had a bad marriage and a worse divorce. They tried to make me perfect to make up for it. Which meant I was isolated from other kids while I studied and practiced sports for every moment I wasn't in school. Nathan was a bright spot in all that stress and pressure. He cultivated my passion for skating, regardless of what I won or didn't win. He made me laugh when I felt like crying and listened to me whenever I needed to vent about what it was like at home. He just wanted me to have fun and learn to get up when I fell down.

The thought that I can help solve this case is honestly the only thing keeping me from falling to pieces right now. I've never done anything like this, but I'll do my best to get up to speed so that we can work this thing out together.

Here's what I know for sure:

There were only seven people at the ice rink around the time Nathan was killed. Which means seven viable suspects: Carol Donnelly, an administrator at the rink; Lillian Varma, Nathan's newest student; Harrison Campbell, Nathan's oldest student; Anne Campbell, Harrison's mother and manager; Kingston Lee, ice skating reporter; Marcus Lourdes, another coach at the rink; and, of course, myself.

I'm a little biased, but I think a great place to start would be clearing me off that list.

You need to prove my innocence, and I think I know how you can do it. There's a security camera by the rink's front door. I know for a fact I left before Nathan died, but the police say there's no footage that proves it. That can't be true. If you access the security portal and send me the file name of a frame of footage that proves my alibi, my name will finally be cleared and we can start making real progress.

I'm sending everything I could find that might help along with this letter. There are more detailed descriptions of each piece of evidence at the case's virtual desktop, which Michelle set up for us to communicate in private. It's at **threepinescase.com**. The password is **AXEL**. You can send the file name to me through the site's messenger. After that, we can figure out our next steps.

Thanks in advance for helping. Talk soon.

Sofia